

Office on a netbook

A new office suite has been announced by Corel, the Corel Home office. This suite has been designed specifically for SoHo environments. It is also said to be netbook friendly as it takes up low memory.

New GPUs

Five new mobile GPUs have been added to the 200M series by NVIDIA. These new GPUs are all based on the 40-nm manufacturing process and are said to be Windows 7 ready

Have you been to Istanbul?

AMD recently launched the world's first six-core server processor under the AMD Opteron series, codenamed Istanbul.

OEMs such as Cray, Dell, HP, IBM and Sun Microsystems are already in the process of churning out new systems based on the new six-core AMD Opteron.

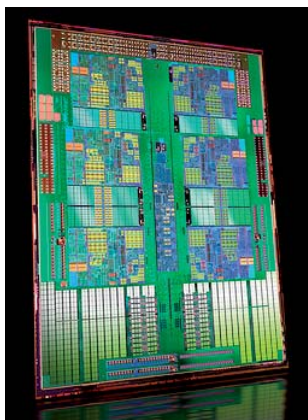
The really great thing about these new processors is that they can be used to field-upgrade existing quad-core Opteron systems as the same Socket-F connector is used. This works out as a real plus point compared to the Intel Nehalem Xeon processors as one would have to go for new mainboards, systems, chipsets and sockets.

The Istanbul comes with a power-efficient DDR2 memory architecture and AMD virtualization technology.

These new processors will already be available by the time you read this and would be a great upgrade to your existing Quad-Core Opteron, as long as your server vendor gives your system the needed BIOS update to move to the new processor.

Obtaining computers is easy

Ncomputing, a low-cost computing solutions company catering to government schemes and even educational institutes, announced recently a partnership with Haier Computer Group. Haier Computer Group, part of the Haier Group, is based in China and along with Ncomputing hope to spread large educational and government computing solutions. Ncomputing is the same organisation that provided computer labs to students in Andhra Pradesh. That was a program implemented by the government to provide computer education to 1.8 million students in Andhra Pradesh.



Ncomputing and Haier have already set the ball rolling as they have accomplished task of "one-computer-per-child" program in the Republic of Macedonia. Along with the help from the Macedonian government, the two groups helped install 1,80,000 computing seats throughout schools which included hardware, software and a network infrastructure. Now these companies are looking into the future as they have set their eyes on governments in Africa, Latin America, Europe and Asia to provide computing opportunities for everybody.

Tweeting to success

Currently, Twitter is known as a micro blogging site that people use for fun and enjoy typing out 140-character status updates to keep their friends and followers informed about what they have been up to. Now with the current world scenario, companies have started using this micro blogging site to post updates about services, offers and contests for people and in turn make a profit. And what is Twitter getting for all this? Nothing, as it is a free to use service.

Recently, Dell also has been Tweeting and has actually made a profit of \$ 3 million, thanks to the followers on Twitter clicking their way through and making purchases on their site. Dell has been using Twitter for the past two years, but saw a significant rise in sales over the last 6 months, as they made more than \$1 million in that time span.

So why are we telling you all this, well the reason Twitter is still free, is because they are unable to come up with a business model to show how their site can rake in the moolah. Well according to a Gartner analyst, all they need to do is show the success of companies such as Dell, who have used the web site to their benefit and they should be set.

Twitter is working on new add-on tools and services for businesses too, but we sure hope this doesn't affect our daily tweeting rituals as nobody would give twitter a second look if you had to pay for using it.

Browser woes

Windows 7 is going to be released worldwide later this year, but in Europe, the retail copy of the latest OS from Microsoft will not come pre-installed with a browser. Internet Explorer, till recently was a part and parcel of the Windows OS. This change of circumstances has evolved due to the pressure from the European Commission, not only that, this was announced just before the ruling of Microsoft's anti-trust charges.

The European regulators also added that Microsoft abuses its dominant status by adding their own internet browser leaving users with no choice on that subject. They had

suggested that other browser be included in the package so consumers can make a choice for themselves, but Microsoft have retaliated by giving European consumers no choice at all.

So guess who benefits from this major move? Google, Mozilla, Opera and Apple as each of them have a browser that can now be installed on the new OS. Internet Explorer is used by about 60 per cent of the world's population connected to the internet, followed by 30 per cent using Firefox, 4 per cent using Opera, and Chrome and Safari make up the rest, according to StatCounter.

The decision to force Microsoft to include options of browsers with Windows 7 is still in discussion, but we will have to wait and watch these turn of events.

The spam fighter

Spam and junk emails are a thing of the past. More recently spam through Short Messaging Service (SMS) has become quite a big thing. Most of you guys might have already faced such an issue of receiving pointless SMS ads and offers that never seem to stop even after activating certain servicing to stop receiving these messages from their service provider. So how does one counter these spam messages?

Not only in India are we facing this problem, but in China too it is not unusual to get at least a dozen SMSes in a single day. Well China has come up with an interesting way to keep the spam under control by limiting the number of SMSes that a single number can send per day. Now you might be thinking how absurd this is, taking away the right to send messages whenever one needs to, but relax it's not that bad either. They have come up with really good numbers that should keep people happy, as a single number cannot send more than 200 messages per hour or 1,000 messages per day on weekdays. For the weekend holidays, the SMS count goes up to 500 per hour or a total of

